How Clear Is the Family's Picture of Who Helps Your Mother?

Twelve quick questions about what the family knows. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how complete the family's picture is. It doesn't measure your mother or the people who help her, and no answer here says whether her routine is working.

1. Is your mother's ordinary week of help written down: who comes by, who calls, who drives, and on which days?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Has your mother looked over that picture and said what is missing or wrong?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Do you know the times of an ordinary day and night when she is on her own?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. For each person who helps, could you say what their help counts on, such as their work schedule or where they live?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Has anyone asked the people who help how it is going on their end?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. For each helper, do you know who could cover if they were away for a week?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Have the people you think of as backups been asked?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Are the small things the family has noticed written down, with where and when?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Do you know whether a professional has already given her any instructions, and where they are written down?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Does the family have the names and phone numbers of her doctor and her pharmacy?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. For each concern or open question, do you know which professional it goes to and who in the family will take it there?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Has the family agreed on what would make you look at all of this again?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what the family knows, not how your mother is doing or how well anyone is helping. A low count means there are things nobody has asked yet, and most of them are one conversation away.

Ready for the next step?

You can see which parts of your mother's support the family knows well and which nobody has asked about. Keep the page you just copied beside you: the care interview goes through her situation area by area and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›